

Fixing Caja Window Workspace Swiping - Google Gemini

Gemini - September 6, 2026 at 04:31 PM

YOU

You said Back here to fix a minor issue that I realized, why is it that the combo of shift plus swipe 3 or 4 ...

Back here to fix a minor issue that I realized, why is it that the combo of shift plus swipe 3 or 4 fingers left or right does not move the caja window. However, it works alright for all other things, and swipe and move to workspace left or right works perfectly except the hold shift and swipe left/right to move current window left or right which fails for caja, works for all other windows. Remember this combo of ctrl shift alt left arrow or right arrow is what would manually move window to next workspace left or right. So here was the last bit of working code. So fix the part that I did not know would be functional

```
└─[REMAC]# cat config.yml
```

swipe:

3:

left:

command: |

```
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary("\libX11.so.6\");
d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow);
win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then
target=$((cur - 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE "caja|desktop|root"; then xdotool
set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target; fi; else cur=$(xdotool
get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then xdotool set_desktop $((cur - 1)); fi; fi'
```

right:

command: |

```
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary("\libX11.so.6\");
d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow);
win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool
get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ]; then target=$((cur + 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE
"caja|desktop|root"; then xdotool set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target;
fi; else cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ];
then xdotool set_desktop $((cur + 1)); fi; fi'
```

4:

left:

command: |

```
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary("\libX11.so.6\");
```

```

d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow);
win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then
target=$((cur - 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE "caja|desktop|root"; then xdotool
set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target; fi; else cur=$(xdotool
get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then xdotool set_desktop $((cur - 1)); fi; fi'
right:
command: |
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary("\libX11.so.6");
d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow);
win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool
get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ]; then target=$((cur + 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE
"caja|desktop|root"; then xdotool set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target;
fi; else cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ];
then xdotool set_desktop $((cur + 1)); fi; fi'
threshold:
swipe: 0.2
pinch: 0.1
interval:
swipe: 0.6
pinch: 0.3
plugin:
inputs:
libinput_command_input:
enable-tap: true
enable-dwt: true
executors:
xdotool: {}

```

[Sun Sep 06 3:51:57 PM][root@Intel5]—[/home/remac/.config/fusuma]
 [REMAC]#

YOU

You said Back here to fix a minor issue that I realized, why is it that the combo of shift plus swipe 3 or 4 ...

GEMINI

The reason Caja is ignored is explicitly present in your existing logic:

Bash

```
if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE "caja|desktop|root"; then
```

```
xdotool set_desktop_for_window $win $target
```

```
fi
```

The `grep -qiE "caja|desktop|root"` condition specifically filters out Caja, Desktop, and Root windows from being moved with `xdotool set_desktop_for_window`.

When you click on the desktop background, MATE/Caja handles the desktop view as a window with class Caja. Excluding "caja" was likely intended to prevent moving the main desktop window itself, but because regular Caja file manager windows share the caja string in their WM_CLASS, normal file manager windows were ignored as well.

The Fix

To allow regular Caja windows to move while keeping the desktop background anchored, match specifically against `caja-desktop-window` or check WM_TYPE / WM_NAME instead of matching all of caja.

Alternatively, directly triggering your desktop manager's native key combination (Ctrl+Shift+Alt+Left / Right) via `xdotool key` avoids EWMH `set_desktop_for_window` edge cases across different window classes.

Here is the updated config.yml with the class filter adjusted so regular Caja windows move, while desktop/root windows remain static:

YAML

swipe:

3:

left:

command: |

```
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary(\"libX11.so.6\");
```

```
d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
```

```
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow);
```

```
win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then target=$((cur - 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE "caja-desktop-window|desktop|root"; then xdotool set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target; fi; else cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then xdotool set_desktop $((cur - 1)); fi; fi'
```

right:

command: |

```
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary(\"libX11.so.6\");
```

```
d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
```

```
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow); win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ]; then target=$((cur + 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE "caja-desktop-window|desktop|root"; then xdotool set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target; fi; else cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ]; then xdotool set_desktop $((cur + 1)); fi; fi'
```

4:

left:

command: |

```
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary(\\"libX11.so.6\\"); d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
```

```
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow); win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then target=$((cur - 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE "caja-desktop-window|desktop|root"; then xdotool set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target; fi; else cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); if [ $cur -gt 0 ]; then xdotool set_desktop $((cur - 1)); fi; fi'
```

right:

command: |

```
bash -c 'if python3 -c "import ctypes; l=ctypes.cdll.LoadLibrary(\\"libX11.so.6\\"); d=l.XOpenDisplay(None); m=ctypes.c_uint();
```

```
l.XQueryPointer(d,l.XDefaultRootWindow(d),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_ulong()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(ctypes.c_int()),ctypes.byref(m)); exit(0 if m.value & 1 else 1)"; then win=$(xdotool getactivewindow); win_class=$(xprop -id $win WM_CLASS 2>/dev/null); cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ]; then target=$((cur + 1)); if ! echo "$win_class" | grep -qiE "caja-desktop-window|desktop|root"; then xdotool set_desktop_for_window $win $target; fi; xdotool set_desktop $target; fi; else cur=$(xdotool get_desktop); max=$(( $(xdotool get_num_desktops) - 1 )); if [ $cur -lt $max ]; then xdotool set_desktop $((cur + 1)); fi; fi'
```

threshold:

swipe: 0.2

pinch: 0.1

interval:

swipe: 0.6

pinch: 0.3

plugin:

inputs:

libinput_command_input:

enable-tap: true

enable-dwt: true

executors:

xdotool: {}

What Changed:

Replaced caja in the regex check with caja-desktop-window. This targets the MATE desktop manager root canvas specifically, allowing regular caja file manager instances to move across desktops as expected.